

the larger agricultural and food ecosystems. Farmers do not operate in silos. Their success depends on multiple interconnected factors—from quality inputs and scientific advisory services to financing, market access, processing, and consumer demand.



Despite advances in digital agriculture, farmers continue to face challenges around productivity, market access, climate risks, and income volatility. Which of these remain the biggest unresolved problems, and where can technology make the greatest difference?

All four challenges remain important, but climate risk is increasingly becoming the underlying factor because it directly influences productivity, pest incidence, water availability, input efficiency, and ultimately farmer incomes.

For farmers, particularly small holders, managing this uncertainty has become one of the most pressing concerns.

Technology can play a significant role in helping farmers build resilience against climate variability and weather-related risks. The biggest opportunity lies in helping farmers move from reactive to

predictive decision-making.

At Godrej Agrovet, our experience has shown that the most effective solutions are those that combine technology with last-mile agronomy and farmer engagement.

However, technology alone is not enough. The real challenge is ensuring that insights are accessible, affordable, and actionable for farmers. Solutions must be designed around farmers' realities, not around technological possibilities.



Will the biggest opportunities in Indian agriculture come from improving productivity at the farm level, strengthening post-harvest infrastructure, building food brands, or creating more efficient value chains?

The biggest opportunity lies in connecting all four.

Strengthening post-harvest infrastructure and improving value-chain efficiency can therefore unlock substantial gains. Changing consumer preferences are creating new opportunities in food brands, traceable supply chains, value-added products, and nutrition-focused offerings.

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silient ventures learnt and pivoted. They began to expand their focus from purely upstream solutions to a more horizontal, integrated model that spans the entire value chain.

One of the prominent examples of this evolution is Patna-based DeHaat, backed by investors like Temasek, Sequoia, and Prosus. Speaking with *Business Today*, Shashank Kumar, co-founder and CEO of DeHaat, says that over the years, the company has expanded beyond inputs and advisory to include market linkages, warehousing, financing and insurance, creating multiple touchpoints across the agricultural ecosystem.

“It’s a crop-agnostic and service-agnostic platform where farmers get access to the entire bundle of key services—from inputs to market access, warehousing, financing and insurance,” says Kumar.

In 2024, the company expanded further downstream with the launch of DeHaat Honest Farms, a consumer brand for food products. Kumar says the objective was to create access to premium consumer markets for farmers, reflecting a broader trend of agritech companies moving beyond farm services and into branded consumer products.

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SHASHANK KUMAR

CO-FOUNDER AND CEO, DEHAAT

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